

Public Law 104–317
104th Congress

An Act

To make improvements in the operation and administration of the Federal courts,
and for other purposes.

Oct. 19, 1996

[S. 1887]

*Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives of
the United States of America in Congress assembled,*

Federal Courts
Improvement Act
of 1996.

SECTION 1. SHORT TITLE; TABLE OF CONTENTS.

28 USC 1 note.

(a) **SHORT TITLE.**—This Act may be cited as the “Federal Courts
Improvement Act of 1996”.

(b) **TABLE OF CONTENTS.**—The table of contents of this Act
is as follows:

Sec. 1. Short title; table of contents.

TITLE I—CRIMINAL LAW AND CRIMINAL JUSTICE AMENDMENTS

Sec. 101. New authority for probation and pretrial services officers.

TITLE II—JUDICIAL PROCESS IMPROVEMENTS

Sec. 201. Duties of magistrate judge on emergency assignment.

Sec. 202. Consent to trial in certain criminal actions.

Sec. 203. Registration of judgments for enforcement in other districts.

Sec. 204. Vacancy in clerk position; absence of clerk.

Sec. 205. Diversity jurisdiction.

Sec. 206. Removal of cases against the United States and Federal officers or agen-
cies.

Sec. 207. Appeal route in civil cases decided by magistrate judges with consent.

Sec. 208. Reports by judicial councils relating to misconduct and disability orders.

**TITLE III—JUDICIARY PERSONNEL ADMINISTRATION, BENEFITS, AND
PROTECTIONS**

Sec. 301. Senior judge certification.

Sec. 302. Refund of contribution for deceased deferred annuitant under the Judicial
Survivors' Annuities System.

Sec. 303. Bankruptcy judges reappointment procedure.

Sec. 304. Technical correction related to commencement date of temporary judge-
ships.

Sec. 305. Full-time status of court reporters.

Sec. 306. Court interpreters.

Sec. 307. Technical amendment related to commencement date of temporary bank-
ruptcy judgeships.

Sec. 308. Contribution rate for senior judges under the judicial survivors' annuities
system.

Sec. 309. Prohibition against awards of costs, including attorney's fees, and injunc-
tive relief against a judicial officer.

TITLE IV—JUDICIAL FINANCIAL ADMINISTRATION

Sec. 401. Increase in civil action filing fee.

Sec. 402. Interpreter performance examination fees.

Sec. 403. Judicial panel on multidistrict litigation.

Sec. 404. Disposition of fees.

TITLE V—FEDERAL COURTS STUDY COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATIONS

Sec. 501. Qualification of Chief Judge of Court of International Trade.